

D295

Designing and Facilitating E-Learning Experiences for K-12 Students

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A seventh-grade teacher who just received a new laptop cart is planning a virtual unit on ratios. She begins by listing three apps students love and building activities around them. What should she have done first?

- A. Choose the most popular app.
- B. Plan how to use the laptop cart.
- C. Write the lesson activities.
- D. Identify the standards and desired results, then the evidence of learning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher has written the standards and the final performance task for a virtual unit. What is the next backward-design step?

- A. Skip planning, since the task is set.
- B. Grade the performance task.
- C. Plan learning activities and choose tools that prepare students for the task.
- D. Rewrite the standards.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A virtual fifth-grade class meets live for 45 minutes on a platform with fun backgrounds. The teacher currently spends 35 of those minutes reading slides aloud. What is the best change?

- A. Add more backgrounds for engagement.
- B. Cancel live sessions, since asynchronous is always better.
- C. Record the slide content for students to watch anytime, and use live time for discussion and feedback.
- D. Extend the live session to 60 minutes.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Students need to practice multiplication facts at their own pace and review a short video as many times as they like. Which format fits best?

- A.** Asynchronous.
- B.** A live lecture.
- C.** Either, since format never matters.
- D.** Synchronous.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

In a virtual middle school with a new logo and mascot, several students post unkind comments about a classmate in a class discussion board. All families signed the acceptable-use policy. What is the best response?

- A.** Rely on the signed policy, since it covers behavior.
- B.** Address the incident and teach a lesson on respectful online communication with practice and clear norms.
- C.** Add a content filter.
- D.** Turn off the discussion board permanently.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A high school chemistry teacher with a professional-grade microphone records a 50-minute video on balancing equations. Analytics show most students stop watching at minute 8. What is the best redesign?

- A.** Rerecord it at 40 minutes.
- B.** Break it into short segments with worked examples and a quick check after each.
- C.** Require students to watch the whole video.
- D.** Buy better audio equipment.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A teacher at a virtual school that recently won a state award assigns a shared slide deck to groups of four with the direction “work together.” One student makes all the slides in each group. What should the teacher add?

- A. Make groups of eight.
- B. Grade only the final deck as a group.
- C. Assign all work individually from now on.
- D. Assigned roles, a clear shared goal, and individual accountability for each member's part.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Revision history shows each student in a group edited only their own assigned section, and each explained a teammate's section in a short check-in. What does this show?

- A. Roles and individual accountability are working.
- B. Only one student did the work.
- C. The group did not collaborate at all.
- D. Revision history is never useful.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

Third graders in a virtual reading class with colorful avatars complete daily phonics practice. The teacher grades the practice at the end of the three-week unit. What change most improves learning?

- A. Let students pick new avatars as rewards.
- B. Add more practice with no feedback.
- C. Grade practice at the end of each week instead.
- D. Use practice with immediate, specific feedback so students fix errors right away.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

An online eighth-grade history teacher with a large collection of primary sources worries students are looking up answers on a multiple-choice test about local government. Which change best supports integrity?

- A.** Ask students to explain how a local government decision affects their own neighborhood, using evidence.
- B.** Shorten the test time for recall questions.
- C.** Rely only on monitoring software.
- D.** Add more primary sources to the test.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

At the start of a virtual science course, a teacher who also coaches robotics has students share a photo of something they are curious about and reply to two classmates. Which presence does this build most?

- A.** Cognitive presence.
- B.** Robotics presence.
- C.** Social presence.
- D.** Teaching presence.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher posts a clear weekly schedule, sets discussion goals, and steps in to redirect off-topic threads. Which presence is this?

- A.** Cognitive presence.
- B.** Teaching presence.
- C.** Social presence.
- D.** All three equally.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A seventh-grade teacher ~~who just received a new laptop cart~~ is planning a virtual unit on ratios. She begins by listing three apps students love and building activities around them. What should she have done first?

Target word: first step of backward design **Decides:** Results come before activities and tools.

A	Inverted operation	Tools come last, not first.
B	Camouflage	Equipment does not set the goal.
C	Dropped element	Skips results and evidence.
D	Correct	Backward design starts with goals, then assessment.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher has written the standards and the final performance task for a virtual unit. What is the next backward-design step?

Target word: next step after stages 1 and 2 **Decides:** Results and evidence are done.

A	Dropped element	Students still need learning experiences.
B	Adjacent category	Grading comes after teaching.
C	Correct	Stage 3 follows goals and evidence.
D	Inverted operation	Goes back to stage 1.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A virtual fifth-grade class meets live for 45 minutes ~~on a platform with fun backgrounds~~. The teacher currently spends 35 of those minutes reading slides aloud. What is the best change?

Target word: use of live time **Decides:** Slide reading can be asynchronous.

A	Camouflage	Cosmetic change.
B	Absolute language	Live time has key uses.
C	Correct	Live time is best for interaction.
D	Wrong stem number	More live lecture is the same problem.

4. Answer A Concept 2 • transfer

Students need to practice multiplication facts at their own pace and review a short video as many times as they like. Which format fits best?

Target word: choose format from the task **Decides:** Self-paced practice and review.

A	Correct	Self-paced practice and repeat viewing.
B	Confusion set	Not self-paced.
C	Absolute language	Format should match the activity.
D	Inverted operation	Live time is better for interaction.

5. Answer B Concept 3

In a virtual middle school ~~with a new logo and mascot~~, several students post unkind comments about a classmate in a class discussion board. All families signed the acceptable-use policy. What is the best response?

Target word: digital citizenship response **Decides:** Policy exists; students need explicit teaching.

A	Dropped element	A policy is not teaching.
B	Correct	Explicit teaching builds citizenship skills.
C	Adjacent category	Filters do not teach respect.
D	Absolute language	Removes the chance to learn and practice.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A high school chemistry teacher ~~with a professional grade microphone~~ records a 50-minute video on balancing equations. Analytics show most students stop watching at minute 8. What is the best redesign?

Target word: video design **Decides:** Long, unsegmented video.

A	Wrong stem number	Still long and unsegmented.
B	Correct	Segmenting supports attention and understanding.
C	Inverted operation	Forces the format rather than fixing it.
D	Camouflage	Audio is not the problem.

7. Answer D Concept 5

A teacher at a virtual school ~~that recently won a state award~~ assigns a shared slide deck to groups of four with the direction “work together.” One student makes all the slides in each group. What should the teacher add?

Target word: structure for collaboration **Decides:** No roles or individual accountability.

A	Wrong stem number	Larger groups make free-riding worse.
B	Dropped element	No individual accountability.
C	Absolute language	Abandons collaboration rather than fixing it.
D	Correct	Structure makes collaboration meaningful.

8. Answer A Concept 5 • transfer

Revision history shows each student in a group edited only their own assigned section, and each explained a teammate's section in a short check-in. What does this show?

Target word: recognize accountability in action **Decides:** Individual parts plus understanding of the whole.

A	Correct	Each contributed and understood the shared work.
B	Confusion set	History shows all contributed.
C	Inverted operation	Explaining teammates' work shows shared understanding.
D	Absolute language	It is a key accountability tool.

9. Answer D Concept 6

Third graders in a virtual reading class ~~with colorful avatars~~ complete daily phonics practice. The teacher grades the practice at the end of the three-week unit. What change most improves learning?

Target word: timing of feedback **Decides:** Feedback comes three weeks late.

A	Camouflage	Not feedback.
B	Dropped element	More practice without feedback can reinforce errors.
C	Adjacent category	Still delayed.
D	Correct	Timely feedback prevents errors from setting in.

10. Answer A Concept 7

An online eighth-grade history teacher ~~with a large collection of primary sources~~ worries students are looking up answers on a multiple-choice test about local government. Which change best supports integrity?

Target word: integrity by design **Decides:** Recall items are easy to look up.

A	Correct	Personal, applied tasks are hard to copy.
B	Adjacent category	Still recall and still lookup-friendly.
C	Absolute language	Monitoring alone does not make tasks authentic.
D	Camouflage	Quantity of sources is not the fix.

11. Answer C Concept 8

At the start of a virtual science course, a teacher ~~who also coaches robotics~~ has students share a photo of something they are curious about and reply to two classmates. Which presence does this build most?

Target word: classify the practice **Decides:** Students connect with each other.

A	Confusion set	About building understanding through inquiry.
B	Camouflage	Not a presence in the framework.
C	Correct	Builds connection among students.
D	Confusion set	About the teacher's design and guidance.

12. Answer B Concept 8 · transfer

A teacher posts a clear weekly schedule, sets discussion goals, and steps in to redirect off-topic threads. Which presence is this?

Target word: classify — reversed from social **Decides:** Design, organization, and facilitation.

A	Adjacent category	About students' inquiry and understanding.
B	Correct	Design and direct guidance by the teacher.
C	Inverted operation	About peer connection.
D	Absolute language	These actions mainly show teaching presence.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	4	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Backward design for virtual units	Start from the standards and desired results, then decide acceptable evidence (assessments), and only then plan online activities and tools.	Starting with a favorite app or activity and adding standards afterward.	The order in which a unit is being planned.
2	Synchronous vs. asynchronous	Use live (synchronous) time for discussion, relationship building, and quick feedback; use asynchronous work for content, practice, and reflection that students can pace themselves.	Spending live sessions on lectures students could watch anytime.	An activity and a choice of when or how it runs.
3	Teaching digital citizenship	Digital citizenship (safety, privacy, respectful communication, digital footprint, source evaluation) is taught explicitly and practiced within units, not handled only by rules or filters.	Relying on a signed acceptable-use policy or content filter alone.	An online behavior problem and a choice among responses.
4	Short, segmented explanations	Explain concepts in short video segments (a few minutes each) with worked examples and a check for understanding after each segment.	Posting one long recorded lecture.	Length and structure of an instructional video.
5	Structured online collaboration	Meaningful collaboration needs a shared goal, defined roles, a structure for contributing, and individual accountability.	Putting students in a breakout room or shared document with only “work together.”	A group task where some students do all the work.
6	Practice with timely feedback	Provide frequent, low-stakes practice with immediate, specific feedback so students correct errors before they set in.	Assigning practice that is graded only after the unit ends.	When and how students learn whether practice answers are right.
7	Integrity by design	Online assessments are more trustworthy when they ask students to apply, explain, or create using personal or local context, rather than relying only on lockdown tools.	Believing monitoring software alone solves academic honesty.	Concern about copying or looking up answers on an online test.
8	Community of Inquiry presences	Online learning needs teaching presence (design and guidance), social presence (students feel connected), and cognitive presence (building understanding through inquiry).	Mixing up social presence with teaching presence.	A described online practice to classify by presence.

Course scope (public description): Designing and Facilitating E-Learning Experiences for K-12 Students is the first of two courses in the K-12 Learning Designer pathway. This course teaches skills needed to plan units of study that leverage virtual settings and achieve academic standards while promoting digital citizenship. This course

provides strategies for explaining essential concepts and demonstrating examples for students in K-12 virtual settings. It also provides strategies for using technology to facilitate meaningful collaboration among K-12 students. Finally, this course explains how to design effective practice and assessment opportunities for K-12 students in virtual settings and provides strategies for ensuring students get the feedback they need to improve learning. Learning Technology is a prerequisite for this course.